

TableX Brand Voice

April 9, 2026 · 8 participants · Anchored in **The Everyman**

Design Thinking Workshop · TableX × Clear pH

BRAND ARCHETYPE

PRIMARY 4 of 8 primary votes (50%)

The Everyman

Belonging, approachable, down-to-earth

The Everyman wants to belong, and believes everyone deserves to. They're the friend, the neighbor, the honest worker — down-to-earth, inclusive, and practical. Brands in this archetype avoid pretense and win by being dependable and relatable, not exclusive.

Exemplar brands: IKEA, Target, Ford, Levi's, Costco, Home Depot, Carhartt, Subaru, Gap, Budweiser

Workshop insight: The team chose Everyman for its honest, practical brand traits — providing a solid foundation for customer connection. TableX is the friend, the neighbor, the honest worker. This archetype rejects pretense and wins by being dependable and relatable, not exclusive. The team explicitly rejected "underdog" positioning in favor of being a "desired brand" that customers choose for quality and service.

SECONDARY 1 primary + 1 secondary

The Outlaw

Revolution, disruption, breaking conventions

The Outlaw breaks the rules that don't serve them. They rebel against the mainstream, embrace risk, and stand for radical freedom. Outlaw brands attract those who feel the system is broken and want a product that signals independence from it.

Exemplar brands: Harley-Davidson, Virgin, Diesel, Red Bull, Supreme, Jack Daniel's, Vans, Dr. Martens, Mini Cooper, MTV

Workshop insight: The Outlaw archetype was embraced as aspirational — emphasizing differentiation by focusing exclusively on tables and innovative configurators. Brian Craig (CEO) selected Outlaw as his primary pick, signaling a desire to disrupt norms in the contract furniture space. This Everyman + Outlaw blend positions TableX as accessible yet bold — the approachable neighbor who doesn't play by the big manufacturers' rules.

FULL VOTE RECORD

The Outlaw	1p + 1s	12%
The Explorer	1p	12%
The Hero	1p + 2s	12%
The Ruler	1p + 1s	12%

COMPETITIVE POSITIONING

Averaged placement of 11 brands across 7 participants.



Workshop insight: The majority of participants positioned TableX in the upper-right quadrant — modern and crafted — signaling high-quality craftsmanship delivered with contemporary sensibilities. Competitors clustered toward mass-produced and traditional, reinforcing TableX's unique market stance. JSI emerged as the closest brand-voice rival in the crafted space, while Enwork and Special-T are direct product-level competitors.

BRAND DNA

40 brand attributes sorted by 6 participants. Showing consensus attributes ($\geq 50\%$ agreement).

IS TableX today	ASPIRATIONAL Where we want to go	IS NOT Actively not us
Honest 100%	Future-ready 100%	Whimsical 100%
Resourceful 100%	Design-forward 100%	Luxurious 100%
Grounded 100%	Refined 100%	Heritage 100%
Ready 100%	Unbothered 100%	Rustic 100%
Solid 83%	Quick 80%	Elegant 100%
Nimble 80%	Crafted 80%	Architectural 50%
Warm 75%	Distinctive 75%	
Reliable 67%	Modern 67%	
Approachable 67%	Playful 67%	
Human 67%	Efficient 60%	
Unfussy 67%	Confident 60%	
Precise 67%	Considered 50%	
Responsive 60%		
Clean 60%		
Traditional 50%		
Tailored 50%		
Quietly ambitious 50%		
Direct 50%		
Essential 50%		
Meticulous 50%		
Tactile 50%		

Workshop insight: High consensus on being *honest* (100%) and *resourceful* (100%) reinforced core values the team already lives. Aspirational traits like *future-ready* and *design-forward* (both 100%) introduced a growth mindset without overcommitting to innovation-heavy positioning. The team consciously differentiated *playful* from *whimsical* — playfulness was embraced as "witty and approachable," while whimsical was unanimously rejected. The contested word was *traditional*: split 50/50, reflecting tension between heritage pride and forward momentum.

THE VOICE

Meet TableX, **the conversational, collaborative table experts**, grounded in Midwest craft.

VOICE SPECTRUM

Averaged across 7 voices. Shaded region shows the room's spread.



Formal–Casual	Leaning approachable (64) ■ high spread
Serious–Playful	Neutral warm (54) ■ high spread
Technical–Simple	Strong plainspoken (74)
Bold–Understated	Strong bold (28) ■ high spread
Traditional–Modern	Leaning modern (68)
Reserved–Enthusiastic	Strong spirited (72) ■ high spread
Corporate–Conversational	Strong conversational (75)
Authoritative–Peer-to-Peer	Strong collaborative (74) ■ high spread

Workshop insight: The data showed a majority preference for casual over formal (64), with an emphasis on being *bold* rather than understated (28 — the strongest conviction on any axis). The team leaned conversational (75) and peer-to-peer (75) — they want to talk *with* customers, not *at* them. The one interesting outlier: *Serious vs. Playful* landed near center (54), reflecting the group's ongoing negotiation between credibility and personality.

VOICE IN PRACTICE

How the team voted on real copy across 4 scenarios — and where they dialed tone on a 5-stop gradient.

Homepage hero **CHEEKY & IRREVERENT**

"Tables. We make them. Really, really well."

Cheeky: 5 · Warm: 1

Product launch — social **WARM & CONVERSATIONAL**

"Meet Meridian — our newest collection, and honestly, our favorite yet. Take a look."

Warm: 3 · Elegant: 2 · Cheeky: 1

Sales email opener **WARM & CONVERSATIONAL**

"Hi [Name] — your work is the kind of stuff we built TableX for. Mind if I send a few pieces I think you'd love?"

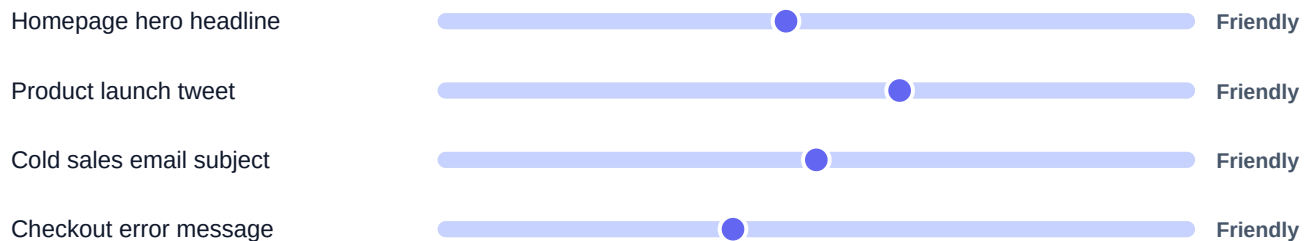
Warm: 4 · Elegant: 1 · Cheeky: 1

Error message **WARM & CONVERSATIONAL**

"Something didn't go through. Give it another shot, or hit us up — we'll sort it out."

Warm: 3 · Elegant: 2 · Cheeky: 1

TONE GRADIENT CONSENSUS



Workshop insight: A clear pattern emerged: the team preferred *cheeky and bold* for outward-facing moments (homepage hero, social) but pulled back toward *warm and earnest* for higher-stakes communications (sales emails, error messages). This "tone flexes by context" finding is exactly what distinguishes a living brand voice from a static one. The team was explicit: "Caution was noted to avoid clownish or excessive whimsy that would undermine seriousness."

IN THEIR OWN WORDS

Raw statements from the team — unedited, authentic, revealing.

Workshop insight: Recurring themes in "We Are": *quality without overhead, partner not vendor, dependable and present*. Brian Craig's "And gosh darn it, people like us" captures the Everyman energy perfectly. The "We Are Not" column reveals what the team actively pushes against: mass-produced, imported, administratively bulky, corporate. Notably, both "we are not a design leader" and "we are not the biggest fish in the pond" show a team that's honest about where they are — and confident that it's a strength.

WE ARE

- We are bold and proud of who we are.
- We are high-quality without the overhead.
- We are your furniture partner and not just a vendor.
- We are a desired brand/product.
- And gosh darn it, people like us.
- We are Tables
- We are your Table Xperts
- We are your every Table need
- We are the easy to do business with
- We are open to ideas and your needs
- We are your source for quality products.
- Our products will be well built.
- We are the company that will try to find solutions to your needs.
- We will give you straight answers to your questions.
- go to company for all your table needs
- We are dependable and always there for our customers
- We are here and we aren't going anywhere.
- We are bold and creative
- We are innovators.
- We are ready to expand our marketing
- We are relatable
- We are reliable and predictable
- We are more of that local friend
- We stand out on our own
- We drive for what we stand for

WE ARE NOT

- We are not mass produced.
- We are not imported.
- We are not administratively bulky.
- We are not your traditional vendor.
- We are not a design leader.
- We are not your only table, we are your every table
- We are not hard to deal with
- We are not closed minded
- We are not your ordinary table company
- We are not your go to table company, yet
- We are not the company with hidden costs or issues.
- We are not KI or one of our competitors
- we do not market our products well
- we are not clowns
- we are not very good at communicating issues with an order
- We are not giants in the industry.
- We are not only here to take your money.
- We are not OFS or Kimball.
- We are not trying to fill your house with junk you don't need to buy
- We are not corporate
- We are not political
- We are not the biggest fish in the pond
- we are not the underdog
- We are not up to date on tech
- We are not in your face

THE FOUR PRINCIPLES

What we measure every future decision against.

Workshop insight: These four principles were selected as the North Star for voice and design decisions.

Approachable emphasizes neighborly, warm interactions over vendor formality. *Grounded* conveys deep roots in practical craftsmanship. *Crafted* focuses on quality that reveals itself over time — "details you'll only notice five years in." *Confident* is about transparency without hedging — messaging should focus on desirability and quiet authority. Together they form a coherent system: a brand that's real, skilled, approachable, and sure of itself.

01 **Crafted** 1 pick

Every edge is a small decision made on purpose.

- Built like the maker has to live with it.
- Quality you can feel before you can name it.
- We sweat the details you'll only notice five years in.
- Heritage techniques, modern tools.
- Slow enough to get it right, fast enough to ship.

02 **Confident** 1 pick

Quietly sure of the work.

- We say what it is. We say what it isn't.
- The proof is in the grain, not the pitch deck.
- We don't oversell — the table does that on the install.
- We stand behind every leg, every leaf, every joint.
- Surefooted, never strutting.

03 **Grounded** 1 pick

Rooted in the shop floor, not the showroom.

- We trust the work to do the talking.
- Honest materials, honest pricing, honest answers.
- Plain-spoken, even when the topic gets technical.
- What you see is what you get — no filter, no front.
- Built on shop-floor logic, not boardroom theory.

04 **Approachable** 1 pick

Neighbors, not vendors.

- We pick up the phone like neighbors, not vendors.
- Easy to spec, easier to live with.
- No pretense, no jargon, no gatekeeping.
- We'd rather be useful than impressive.
- Furniture that invites you to put your feet up — and means it.